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Mass. town squares off with battery park

Proposed energy project in Oakham sparks concerns over drinking water

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

OAKHAM — There are strange mounds out here in the woods, among the stands of red oaks and hickories, that on closer inspection aren't part of the natural contours of the land.

They are antiquated piles of tires and car bumpers, old transmissions, and motorcycle gas tanks. The automotive parts have been here for years and appear embedded in the earth, covered with leaves and dirt; others have plants sprouting from them.

For a half-century, this was a junkyard, and it's now the backdrop to a pitched battle between this tiny, rural Worcester County community — population around 1,900 — and an energy company that wants to build a battery park on this property and state officials who are regulating that process.

Locals, citing project concerns about noise, fire risk, and potential contamination of a system that provides 2.5 million state customers with water, among other ills, say the future of this community, located **BATTERIES, Page A10**



CHRISTIAN KANTOSKY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Matt Broderick showed the site of a proposed lithium battery storage facility in Oakham on Wednesday.

For college athletes, a season of uncertainty

Universities pare rosters amid compensation rulings

By Sophie Endrud
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

WASHINGTON — As college students begin the annual migration back to campus, many of the athletes among them are returning to a state of limbo.

A series of recent court decisions and settlements aimed at resolving questions about compensation and eligibility for student athletes has had an unintended consequence: a number of schools have reduced the rosters of some sports programs and eliminated others entirely as they redirect money to the highest-earning sports.

There won't be any athletes returning to the diving team at the University of Virginia or at California Polytechnic State University's swimming team, or over 40 Olympic sports programs in NCAA Division I that have had their rosters eliminated over the past two years. The changes are effectively trade-offs in which schools choose to compensate some previously unpaid athletes on the biggest teams but take away opportunity for those in some lower-profile programs.

"A lot of us in non-revenue sports are worried about our sports still being here in a few years," said Gannon Flynn, a rising junior on the men's swimming team at Boston University who transferred to the school after being cut due to roster constraints at the University of Utah.

Hope had been building over the summer that Congress would act to resolve this issue and many **NCAA, Page A7**

'When I see these kids now, and they're hearing, . . . that is just amazing.'

DR. A. ELIOT SHEARER, ear, nose, and throat surgeon at Boston Children's Hospital



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Andrew Tynes snuggled with his 16-month-old son, Everett, before the toddler's surgery at Boston Children's Hospital.

Conquering the silence

Gene therapy offers toddler a chance to hear naturally, without an implant or other aid

By Brianna Abbott
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Everett Tynes sat upright in his hospital bed, blowing raspberries and flipping through a children's book that played music he couldn't hear.

Just 16 months old, Everett has been deaf since birth. He has a rare genetic variant that prevents sound signals in his inner ear from reaching his brain. But he was at Boston Children's Hospital in early August to undergo a remarkable treatment designed to restore his

ability to hear: a new, working copy of his defective gene delivered to his inner ear.

"A lot of it is about Everett's experience with the world around him," said Leah Hamel, 39, Everett's mom. "I do think he'll have access to more things if he has access to speech and hearing."

The gene therapy he received, called Otarmeni, was approved in April and is the first such treatment of its kind in the US. And Everett was the first patient at Boston Children's to receive the therapy after its approv-

al. Others are in the research pipeline.

On the morning of his surgery, Everett had to skip breakfast, and so was a little cranky. His father, Andrew, lay on the bed and rested Everett on top of him.

"Dude, you could just take a nap now, what do you think?" Andrew Tynes asked.

Everett fell asleep on his dad's chest before the nurses wheeled him into surgery.

Genetics are responsible for about half of hearing loss cases in newborns, and there are approximately 150 different known genes that can malfunction and lead to deafness. Now, therapies designed to restore or modify a person's genes are offering hope to families that their children would be able to hear nat-

THERAPY, Page A10

Sixth District tactics reflect divided party

Koh embraces role with Biden; rivals run away

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

ANDOVER — Keith Wentzel was torn. The North Andover resident liked two of the Democrats running in the crowded Sixth Congressional District primary but was undecided about whether to back state Representative Tram Nguyen or Dan Koh, a longtime aide to former US labor secretary and Boston mayor Martin J. Walsh.

But who was there Wednesday in an Andover park to help with that decision? None other than Marty Walsh himself.

Koh, he said, would "be a freshman in Congress, but he's not a freshman," Walsh told Wentzel as a local band accented their conversation. The difference between the two candidates, Walsh said, is "having lived experience in the political world."

The exchange encapsulated Koh's approach, and the kind of help he's getting, in the six-way primary. As Democrats here and elsewhere try to pitch voters on the need for wholesale change, Koh **SIXTH DISTRICT, Page A7**



Drops a hint

Monday: Humid and drizzly. High 72-77, low 65-70.

Tuesday: The sun returns. High 75-80, low 65-70. Sunrise: 5:53. Sunset: 7:42.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **C9.**

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The deadline for President Trump's cease-fire plan with Iran is set to elapse Monday as the conflict becomes an economic battle. **A3.**

Undocumented workers are finding themselves victims of wage theft and the subject of threats of deportation. **D1.**

From liberal arts colleges to research institutions, campuses are introducing majors tied into artificial intelligence. **B1.**

Officials look for ways to tame crowded, chaotic New York Harbor after the capsizing of a charter boat killed a mother and her infant daughter. **A2.**

Tommy John has died. The longtime pitcher lent his name to an elbow surgery that has saved the careers of hundreds of other players. **C9.**

The Sox dropped their series finale to the Pirates, 8-3. **C1.**

At the cross-currents of American history

This revolutionary helped save Washington's army. Should his decrepit farmhouse also be saved?

By Brian MacQuarrie
GLOBE STAFF

SWAMPSCOTT — The dilapidated, two-story, wood-frame house sits neglected at the edge of the cracked pavement of an unused parking lot. Weeds sprout from the buckled asphalt, and a tarp thrown across the building's roof is tattered and torn.

The farmhouse is a vacant, decrepit eyesore off a busy North Shore crossroads, but it also is the former home of General John Glover, a Revolutionary War hero whose famed Marblehead Regiment of mariners played a critical role in the fight for independence.

Now, nearly 250 years since Glover's troops ferried General George Washington and his soldiers across the Delaware River to an early, essential patriot victory at Trenton, the future of his farmhouse is uncertain.

National Development, a Newton-based company, is eyeing the four-acre site off Vinnin Square for a large apartment complex, local officials said. Negotiations continue over its purchase, exactly what the parcel would look like, and who would oversee it in the years to come.

That uncertainty has prompted anxious speculation. For many residents in Swampscott and neighboring Marble-



FILE 2004

Reenactors with Glover's Marblehead Regiment engaged at Gas House Beach in Marblehead.

head, the answer is simple: Preserve the house.

"When I look back at the contributions that Glover made to the founding of the country and getting our freedom, it's

something that coming generations need to be aware of," said Larry Sands, the captain of Glover's Regiment, a Marblehead unit composed of dozens **GLOVER, Page A6**